

Nebuchadnezzar, the murder of Gedaliah, and the circumstances under which the prophet, against his will, was brought into Egypt: 43, 8-13 is a prophecy uttered by him upon the arrival of the refugees at Tahpanhes (Daphnae), declaring the future conquest of Egypt by Nebuchadnezzar.

39, 1-14 connects imperfectly with c. 38, v. 1 going back to the *beginning* of the siege. It seems (in spite of their being in the LXX) that the words in vv. 1-2 from *In the ninth year* to *in the city* (which cannot be legitimately treated as a parenthesis, as in RV.) are an interpolation on the basis of 52, 4. 6f. 39, 4-13 is omitted in LXX, and it is doubtful if it forms part of the original narrative: the connexion of v. 4 with v. 3 is imperfect, and in any case vv. 4-10 are merely *abridged* from 2 Ki. 25, 4-12 (comp. esp. v. 8 with 2 Ki. 25, 8-10), according to the purer and more original text still preserved in Jer. 52, 7-16. Most probably the original text had only 39, 1 (to *taken*). 3 [with *and* for *that*, as in the Heb.]. 14 [Heb. *and they sent*]: these words form a continuous narrative, the particulars in which are *not* borrowed from c. 52 (so Ew. Hitz. Graf, Kuen. Orelli,—Hitz. and Or., however, including v. 11 f. as well). 39, 15-18 is a supplement to c. 38, promising a reward to Ebed-melech on account of the services rendered by him to Jeremiah.

C. 44. Jeremiah here rebukes the fugitives in Egypt for relapsing into their old idolatries: they excuse themselves; the prophet, in reply, repeats his previous denunciations, declaring that of their entire body, a handful only should return into the land of Judah.

C. 45 is a short prophecy, containing words of mingled reassurance and reproof, addressed to Baruch in the depression and disappointment which overcame him, after writing the roll of the 4th year of Jehoiakim, at the near and certain prospect of his country's ruin. He is reminded that the age is one in which he must not expect great things for himself, but must be content if he escapes with his bare life.

C. 46-51 form the book of Jeremiah's prophecies concerning foreign nations, grouped together, as in the case of the similar prophecies in the Books of Isaiah (c. 13-23) and Ezekiel (c. 25-32). The prophecies are closely connected with c. 25 (most of the nations to which they refer being named in 25, 19-26), and indeed in the text of the LXX are inserted in it.<sup>1</sup>

C. 46. On *Egypt*. This falls into two parts: (1) vv. 3-12 an

<sup>1</sup> They follow 25, 13, the words in 25, 13<sup>b</sup> "which," &c., in the form, "The things which Jeremiah prophesied against the nations," forming a superscription; v. 14 being omitted; and vv. 15 (in the form, "Thus said Jehovah," &c.). 16-38 following at the end.